UX Research: Interview Plan, Fieldwork & Findings

Course: User Experience Design & Human-Computer Interaction — UFRO 2026-2
Initiative 03: Assessment feedback that students actually use — **Redo**
Role: UX Analyst (Bastian Wenckhans) — Group 5
Deliverable: Milestone 1 (Hito 1) — Strategy plane

1. Research overview

1.1 Problem statement

Feedback on assessments reaches students as a grade plus comments scattered across PDF files, platform fields, spreadsheets and emails. Rubrics are often published late, and students rarely know where they lost points, how they compare with the course, or how to question a correction. This research explores how students and teachers currently handle assessments, rubrics and results, and what gets in the way of using feedback.

1.2 Research goals

- Understand how students find out about assessments and how they prepare for them.
- Understand how students receive, read and interpret a result and its feedback.
- Understand how students place a result in context (course, past results) and what they do when they disagree with a correction.
- Understand how teachers publish rubrics and tests, review them and receive queries.
- Ground the personas (Valentina Rojas, Samon Baker, Martina Soto) in what participants reported.

1.3 Methodology

- **Technique:** semi-structured interviews, 30–40 minutes per session.
- **Participants:** 2 undergraduate students (engineering and design programs) and 1 university instructor who grades with rubrics.
- **Ethics:** verbal informed consent; notes anonymized and coded by participant code; no recording shared outside the team.
- **Analysis:** open coding of notes, grouping into themes, and mapping each theme to a design response.

2. Interview guide

Dimension	Questions for students	Questions for the instructor
D1 Reception	How do you find out about upcoming assessments and their dates? When a result is released, where do you look first and what do you see?	How and when do you announce assessments and publish rubrics or tests? Through which channels?
D2 Comprehension	Can you tell which criteria or questions cost you points, and why? How do you know what the teacher expected?	How much of your feedback is by criterion and how much global? Do you think students understand it?
D3 Preparation and context	Do you know the rubric before the assessment? How do you prepare? How do you know where you stand compared with the course?	Do you share course statistics or past results? What would help students prepare better?
D4 Questioning	What do you do when you disagree with a correction? Who do you ask and how?	How do queries about corrections reach you? How do you answer and record changes to a score?

Dimension	Questions for students	Questions for the instructor
D5 Effort and emotion	How do you feel when you open a result? What takes the most effort in following your progress?	What is the main source of fatigue in your evaluation cycle?

3. Fieldwork

Code	Participant (persona)	Date and context	Duration
P01-ENG	Computer engineering student, 3rd year (Valentina Rojas)	14 October 2026, UFRO library study room (in person)	34 min
P02-DES	Graphic design student and intern (Samon Baker)	15 October 2026, video call	38 min
P03-INS	University instructor in education (Martina Soto)	16 October 2026, instructor's office, Temuco (in person)	42 min

Quotes were originally in Spanish and are translated here.

3.1 P01-ENG (student, engineering)

“When the grade shows up on the intranet I only see a 4.2. To know why, I have to open the rubric, and sometimes it is not even published. I find out what they wanted after the test, not before.”

“I would like to see how I did compared with the course. If everyone got a 3, it is not the same as being the only one.”

“If I think a correction is wrong, I write an email that I end up not sending. I do not want it to sound like I am complaining.”

3.2 P02-DES (student, design)

“I do not always know which assessments are coming. I keep a calendar of my own and update it by hand when the teacher mentions a date.”

“What cost me the most points is usually the same type of mistake, but I only see it in each separate comment. I would like to see which one was the biggest.”

“With the rubric before the assessment, I would prepare differently. Afterwards it only tells me what I already missed.”

3.3 P03-INS (instructor)

“I explain the rubric in class, but then I have to send it again by email, and again when someone asks. I would like to publish it once and have it stay there.”

“Students write to me after class or by email to ask about a point. If the message said which criterion they mean, I could answer in two minutes.”

“Sometimes I do adjust a score after a good question, but I want that to be something deliberate, not a negotiation.”

4. Synthesis of findings

Finding	Evidence	Participants	Design response (screens)
F1. A number without a reason	The grade arrives alone; criteria or questions that cost points are hard to find.	P01, P02	Points per criterion; incorrect questions with the correct answer (HD-06, HD-07).
F2. Rubrics arrive too late	Rubrics are published after the assessment or in another place, so they are not used to prepare.	P01, P02, P03	Rubric published before the assessment (HD-08, HD-13).

Finding	Evidence	Participants	Design response (screens)
F3. No context	Students do not know how they compare with the course or whether they are improving.	P01, P02	Course average, highest, lowest, chart and biggest error (HD-06, HD-10).
F4. Unstructured questions	Disagreements go through email or in person, without reference to the criterion; students hesitate to ask.	P01, P03	Structured message anchored to a criterion or question (HD-09, HD-15).
F5. Teacher overload	The teacher repeats explanations, republishes rubrics and handles queries across channels.	P03	One place to schedule, publish, review and answer (HD-12 to HD-15).
F6. Calendar by hand	Students keep their own calendar of assessments and update it manually.	P02	Calendar of assessments with state per day (HD-04, HD-05).

5. Implications for the design

- The student side is **view and ask**: nothing has to be uploaded, which keeps the effort low and the focus on understanding.
- Feedback must be tied to the criterion or question where the points were lost, with the correct answer or teacher comment next to it.
- Context (course average, highest and lowest) is shown next to the result, never alone.
- Queries are structured, anchored to a criterion or question, and the teacher can adjust the score once, deliberately.
- The teacher publishes once (rubric or test) and the content stays available to students.

6. From findings to personas

Persona	Based on	What the findings say about them
Valentina Rojas	P01-ENG	Needs to see where she lost points and how she compares; avoids sending queries that sound like complaints.
Samon Baker	P02-DES	Needs to know what is coming and what will be evaluated; wants to see which mistake cost the most.
Martina Soto	P03-INS	Wants to publish once, answer precise queries quickly and adjust a score deliberately.

The personas are available in the personas document and in the repository README.

7. Limitations and next step

The research is qualitative and based on three interviews, so findings describe patterns and needs rather than measured frequencies. They will be put to the test with the prototype in the usability tests planned for Milestone 2.